Diego Javier Piña Lopez, LMSW, MPA

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Nonprofit executive and Arizona Licensed Master Social Worker with more than a decade of experience building immigrant and refugee services, community partnerships, and accountable nonprofit operations. Advanced from volunteer and social work field placement to Executive Director of Casa Alitas. Led a $12 million, multi-site humanitarian response serving up to 1,800 people nightly with 62 staff and more than 800 volunteers. Skilled in aligning budgets, people, reporting, and partnerships during rapid change, while developing teams and supporting community leadership.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Therapist (LMSW) — Amanah Bloom Counseling | Tucson, AZ | Jul 2026–Present

- Provide strengths-based, client-centered counseling.
- Work collaboratively with clients from diverse backgrounds and life stages, emphasizing dignity, individual strengths, and their own goals for change.
- Develop group therapy activities that incorporate games and support therapeutic goal setting.

Researcher & Content Expert — Cherokee Federal | Remote | Apr 23 – Aug 25

- Prepared operational reports for public-sector partners documenting shelter capacity, emerging needs, and changes affecting displaced people, supporting timely planning and resource decisions.
- Assessed health and social-service capacity for displaced Afghan populations across the United States through community meetings and assessments of employment barriers.
- Developed dashboards to compare resettlement resources and inform regional planning.
- Advised shelter partners on referral processes, service coordination, and longer-term settlement pathways.
- Managed a 10-person Arizona case-management team, supporting staff priorities, employer partnerships, refugee job placements, and follow-up services.

Executive Director — Catholic Community Services of Southern Arizona | Tucson, AZ | Aug 19 – May 24

- Advanced from volunteer and MSW field placement to Executive Director, linking frontline experience with organizational planning, staff development, and community relationships.
- Directed a $12 million multi-site shelter and reception system serving up to 1,800 people nightly, balancing service continuity, funding uncertainty, safety, and changing arrival volumes.
- Coordinated 62 staff members and more than 800 volunteers across multiple sites, aligning roles, staffing capacity, and community partnerships during rapid expansion.
- Mobilized interfaith, consular, public-sector, and nonprofit partners to expand emergency shelter capacity and serve more than 8,000 people in a single week.
- Collaborated with the organizational team to secure more than $13 million in public and philanthropic support in one year, connecting resources to operating needs and funder commitments.
- Developed operational and demographic reporting to inform staffing, budgets, service decisions, and communication with funders and government partners.
- Supported culturally responsive services and delegated project-level decisions to immigrant community leaders while retaining safety and compliance oversight.

Consultant — Catholic Charities USA | Remote | Sep 22 – Jun 24

• Designed and coordinated cross-organizational referral workflows and data systems connecting border-service agencies with case-management partners in interior U.S. cities.

• Facilitated shared planning among geographically dispersed organizations, clarifying roles, service expectations, and partner communication.

• Developed program indicators and reporting tools to track case-management service interactions and outcomes.

• Conducted individual and group meetings with participating agencies to identify data-system challenges and additional support needs.

Senior Border Specialist — Save the Children | Jul 21 – Oct 22

• Coordinated U.S. border-response programs and partnerships with humanitarian organizations.

• Contributed to program planning, implementation, and resource and funding allocation within a $7M humanitarian response portfolio.

• Organized monthly interagency partner meetings with government, NGOs, and international NGOs.

BOARD LEADERSHIP & GOVERNANCE

Center for Victims of Torture — Board Member (2023 – Present)

• Participated in the Policy and Advisory Committee and the CEO search committee, contributing to governance and organizational leadership.

Kaleidoscope Humanitarian Aid — Founding Board Member & Secretary (2025 – Present)

• Helped establish the organization's governance framework, bylaws, and board procedures.

RECOGNITION & AWARDS

• Invitee, White House Hispanic Heritage Month Celebration, 2023.

• Community Partner Award — National Association of Social Workers, Arizona Chapter, 2022.

• Community Service Award — Southern Arizona Legal Aid, 2020.

• Emerging Leader of the Year — National Association of Social Workers, Arizona Chapter, 2019.

• Emerging Social Worker of the Year — National Association of Social Workers, Arizona Chapter, 2019.

• Kindness Award — Ben’s Bells Project, 2019.

EDUCATION

Master of Social Work (MSW) — Arizona State University, 2019

Master of Public Administration (MPA) — Arizona State University, 2018

Bachelor of Arts — Theater Education, University of Arizona, 2013

Bachelor of Arts — Religious Studies, University of Arizona, 2013

LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT

• Arizona Community Foundation — CEO Survival Course (for NGOs) (2026)

• Board Leadership Training Program — Completed 2026

PROFESSIONAL CREDENTIALS

Arizona Licensed Master Social Worker (LMSW) | UNICEF Psychological First Aid — Train-the-Trainer (2021)

MEDIA ENGAGEMENT

CNN — Fredricka Whitfield | Reuters — Ted Hesson & Liliana Salgado | NPR — Joel Rose | NPR — Ximena Bustillo | New York Times — Jack Healy